AI FOR MANAGERS · STUDY GUIDE

Amplify – Building Collective Capability

How do I turn one person's useful finding into bounded, reusable team knowledge?

MODULE 5 · LESSON 4 | LEAD: CAPABILITY | Action lesson · 10–12 min

THE CORE IDEA

Individual learning becomes team capability only when it is surfaced, examined, spread, and retained.

Sharing alone isn't enough – a tip can be misunderstood, overgeneralized, forgotten, or left with the same few people.

1 Learning stays private by default

On many teams, people using AI are still learning partly on their own. One person has worked out something that gets consistently better results – few colleagues know. Another has found AI useful for one stage of the process and unreliable for another – never discussed. A third tried something that failed and moved on – so someone else will repeat the attempt. The **Amplify** role turns what one person learns into something the team can use, in four steps: **Surface** → **Examine** → **Spread** → **Retain**.

2 Surface: get it said out loud

Most AI learning never is. The easiest way in is a conversation you're already having – a one-to-one, a task discussion – where you hear something and think: that might be worth something for the team. On top of that, put one recurring question into a meeting you already have: **"Has anyone learned something about using AI since we last asked – something that worked, something that didn't, something worth sharing?"** Go first, and share something real – including a failure; failures rarely get volunteered, but they're often the most useful thing in the room. Push past speed tips toward **judgment**: where someone didn't trust the output, where AI broke down, what they changed. Learning picked up outside – a course, a community, a conference – feeds the same sequence. And silence doesn't mean nothing's there: try collecting findings in writing, or ask one person ahead of time.

3 Examine: pin down the conditions

A raw finding is too compressed to hand to anyone else – "this prompt works," "AI is bad at this." Before the team runs with it, pin down when it works and what judgment it still takes – usually right in the same conversation.

QUESTIONS THAT MAKE A FINDING REUSABLE

1. What task or work was this for – and have you actually tried it here, or seen it elsewhere?
2. What specifically worked or failed?
3. How do you know – did it hold up once, or every time?
4. What did you have to change, check, or decide yourself?
5. Where would you *not* use this?

Note: save these for findings that could change how someone works. And don't force everything into a "best practice" – sometimes the honest answer is "worked once, needs more evidence." That's fine.

4 Spread: make it travel

Mentioning something once isn't spreading it – spreading means someone else can actually pick it up. Three ways: **show it** – a walk-through on a real example, including what was checked or changed; **pair people up** – two people with similar work compare notes and keep what holds up for both; **test it on real work** – someone else tries it on a low-risk task and reports what carried over. Most of this fits meetings you already run. One nudge: don't let the teaching all land on your most advanced user – sharing is part of the work, not a favor.

5 Retain: make it findable

A finding that lives only in a meeting or chat thread is gone in a week. Capture the useful ones where the team already looks – a shared doc, a wiki, a pinned channel – in whatever form is quickest: a short doc, a two-minute video, a screenshot with a caption. Enough to reuse: what the work was, what worked or failed, and the limits – what still needs a human check, where not to use it. Keep it **team memory, not a rulebook**. And when a finding is strong enough to change how the whole team works, don't quietly turn it into a rule: agree it with the team and update the **Team Working Standard**.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY AFTER THIS LESSON

- Install one recurring learning question in a meeting you already run – and go first, failure included.
- Treat judgment, not speed tips, as the learning most worth spreading.
- Examine before the team runs with anything: where it works, where it doesn't, what it still takes.
- Spread through a person or a task – a demo, a pairing, a low-risk test – never a one-time mention.
- Retain the useful findings, and record the run as the Amplify entry in your **Lead AI Adoption Plan**.

Module 5 · Lead: Capability – the module that turns the standard into durable capability through four ongoing roles. **Next: Lesson 5.5 – Scout – Finding Where AI Can Add Real Value** – the role that looks forward, at what nobody has tried yet.